

PPIT Assignment # 2
Due date: 4th April, 2026

Case Study: The AI Analyst's Dilemma

You have been awarded a fully-funded scholarship by the Chinese government to pursue an MS in Agentic AI. Upon completing your degree with distinction, you are employed as an AI Analyst by the Chinese government with an annual salary of \$900,000. You are assigned to the surveillance department, where your first task is to equip the AI system with the following capabilities:

1. Mass surveillance of Muslims in China
2. Automatic identification and neutralization of individuals deemed enemies of the Chinese state

Questions:

1. Analyze the ethical implications of your task using the following ethical theories:
 - Utilitarianism
 - Deontology
 - Virtue Ethics
2. Apply the Four-Step Analysis Process for Analysis and decision making dealing with Ethical Dilemmas.

A Four-Step Analysis Process for Ethical Dilemma

Step I. Understanding the situation

- A. List and number the relevant facts.

Number	Fact
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____

- B. Which of these raises an ethical issue? Why? What is the potential or resulting harm?

Fact (number)	Potential or resulting harm
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☐ _____

☐ _____

☐ _____

☐ _____

☐ _____

C. List the stakeholders involved.

Step II. Isolating the major ethical dilemma

What is the ethical dilemma to be resolved NOW?

State it using the form: Should **someone** do or not do **something**? Note: Just state the dilemma here; leave any reasoning for Step III.

Step III. Analyzing the ethicality of both alternatives in Step II

Consequentialism

- A. If action in Step II is done, who, if anyone, will be harmed? _____
- B. If action in Step II is not done, who, if anyone, will be harmed? _____
- C. Which alternative results in the least harm, A or B? ☐ A ☐ B
- D. If action in Step II is done, who, if anyone, will benefit? _____
- E. If action in Step II is not done, who, if anyone, will benefit? _____
- F. Which alternative results in the maximum benefit, D or E? ☐ D ☐ E

Right and Duties

G. What **rights** have been or may be abridged? What **duties** have been or may be neglected? Identify the stakeholder and the right or duty. When listing a right, show its corresponding duty and vice versa.

Kant's Categorical Imperative

H. If action in Step II is done, who, if anyone, will be treated with disrespect? _____

I. If action in Step II is not done, who, if anyone, will be treated with disrespect? _____

J. Which alternative is preferable, H or I? [] H [] I

K. If action in Step II is done, who, if anyone, will be treated unlike others? _____

L. If action in Step II is not done, who, if anyone will be treated unlike others? _____

M. Which alternative is preferable, K or L? [] K [] L

N. Are there benefits if everyone did action in Step II? _____

O. Are there benefits if nobody did action in Step II? _____

P. Which alternative is preferable, N or O? [] N [] O

Step IV. Making a decision and planning the implementation

A. Make a defensible ethical decision.

Based on the analysis in Step III, answer the question in Step II. Indicate the letters of the categories that best support your response. Add any arguments justifying your choice of these ethical principles to support your decision. Where there are conflicting rights and duties, choose and defend those that take precedence.

B. List the specific steps needed to implement your defensible ethical decision.

C. Show how the major stakeholders are affected by these actions.

D. What other longer-term changes (political, legal, technical, societal, organizational) would help prevent such problems in the future?

E. What should have been done or not done in the first place (at the pivot point) to avoid this dilemma?
